

APPLES *Malus domestica*

The quintessential tree fruit, apples offer an astounding array of varieties, wide-ranging fruit flavors, and a large choice of training forms, from freestanding trees and wall-trained cordons, to compact stepovers and standards. Choose a baking apple such as 'Bramley's Seedling' for a classic apple crisp, or choose a dessert variety such as 'Jonagold' or 'Cox's Orange Pippin' for a tasty snack straight from the tree.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
PLANT				
HARVEST				

PLANTING

If you are buying a container-grown tree, ensure that it is healthy and has not become root-bound. Although container-grown trees can be planted at any time of year, it is preferable to plant them either in spring or fall. Bare-root trees should be planted between the fall and early spring, as long as the soil is not frozen.

Apple tree cultivars vary in fertility—some are self-fertile, some are diploid, requiring another pollenizer, and some are triploid, requiring two other pollenizers (see individual cultivar entries for specific information), so make sure that you plan carefully, and, if in doubt, seek the advice of a specialist when buying your trees.



Select certified disease-free trees.

Although they are not as frost-sensitive as other fruit trees, apples like a warm, sheltered site, with full sun for dessert varieties. Give trees a fertile, well-drained soil with a pH of about 6.5 and ensure that trees have enough space to develop comfortably: dwarfing trees may need as little as 4 ft (1.2 m) of space between